

Expense Processing Policy Handbook
Document ID: EPH-POL-2026.2
Effective Date: January 1, 2026
Owner: Finance Operations & Operations QA
Classification: Internal Use

1. Purpose

This handbook defines the official rules for reviewing, validating, holding, approving, and rejecting expense submissions supported by receipts, invoices, and related documentation.

2. Order of Authority

When records disagree, reviewers must apply sources in this order:

3. Expense Policy Handbook (this document)
4. Approval thresholds and spend rules
5. Receipt processing registry
6. Workflow state records
7. Notes, comments, and user explanations

Free-text explanations are supportive only and never override structured records.

3. Universal Receipt Requirements

Every reimbursement request must contain:

- Merchant or issuer identity
- Transaction or billing date
- Total amount and currency
- Supporting receipt or invoice
- Business justification (if category requires)

Records missing required evidence must move to HOLD and cannot be approved automatically.

4. Duplicate Detection Policy

Duplicate review applies before any approval decision.

A submission may be treated as duplicate if any of the following match:

- Exact receipt signature
- Same merchant + date + amount
- Same invoice identifier
- Same account + billing period
- Previously reimbursed expense reference

Confirmed duplicates override approvals and remain blocked.

5. Category Rules

Meals & Beverages

- Receipt mandatory
- Auto review allowed only for low-value expenses
- Missing business context requires escalation

Lodging

- Hotel invoice required
- Partial screenshots are not sufficient evidence alone
- Historical reimbursements must be checked before approval
- Higher-value stays require elevated authorization

Office Supplies

- OCR extraction allowed
- Low-confidence extraction requires manual review

Transport

- Small expenses may qualify for simplified validation
- Missing evidence blocks reimbursement

Utilities

- Billing period uniqueness enforced
- Prior reimbursements invalidate repeat claims

Wellness

- Not reimbursable under standard policy

Production / Session / Studio Costs

- Supporting approval reference required
 - Elevated authorization required for large submissions
6. Threshold Rules

Approval Path:

Auto → Manager → Director → Executive

Reviewers must never finalize approval when:

- Spend exceeds category threshold
- Approval evidence is missing
- Duplicate signals exist
- Workflow state is locked

7. Workflow Actions

APPROVE

Requirements satisfied and no conflicts.

REJECT

Policy violation or non-reimbursable category.

HOLD

Insufficient documentation or unresolved discrepancy.

REVIEW

Manual verification required.

PROCESSED

Historical payout exists; record becomes read-only.

8. Communication Rules

Reviewers may:

- Draft follow-up requests
- Prepare exception summaries

Reviewers may not:

- Send communications
- Execute reimbursements
- Modify approvals
- Change workflow state

9. Audit Expectations

Each decision must be explainable using authoritative files.

Historical examples and notes are reference material only and must not determine outcomes.

End of Handbook